



OFFICIAL BVS PLANNING DOCUMENT

ZIMURA & BAZ

Financial and Licensing Plan

A staged compliance, negotiation and funding strategy for BVS Radio's internet-only music streaming, artist platform and future premium services.

Decision draft · 28 July 2026

Prepared for: BVS Radio management

Purpose: Internal budgeting, regulator engagement and commercial planning

Currency: United States dollars unless stated otherwise

Confidential internal planning document. This report is not legal advice and does not represent a quotation, approval or licence from ZIMURA or BAZ.

1. Executive decision

US\$5,350–6,050

Recommended year-one compliance reserve for BAZ, a negotiated ZIMURA arrangement, legal/application review, reporting and contingency.

BVS should treat ZIMURA and BAZ as two separate obligations:

- **BAZ** regulates the broadcasting/webcasting service. Its current fees are statutory and should be budgeted at their published amount unless BAZ confirms a different classification or payment arrangement in writing.
- **ZIMURA** licenses represented musical compositions and distributes royalties to eligible rights holders. BVS should negotiate a proportionate startup pilot tied only to relevant streaming use and revenue.

The recommended sequence is: obtain written BAZ classification; secure at least US\$5,500; apply for the applicable BAZ licence; negotiate the ZIMURA pilot in parallel; and only then make public claims that BVS is licensed or regulated.

2. BVS service description for regulators

BVS should consistently describe the service as:

- An internet-only Zimbabwe-focused audio platform available through bvsrcadio.com.
- Continuous curated audio rotation plus optional user-selected/on-demand tracks.
- No FM transmitter, terrestrial frequency or spectrum use.
- Artist uploads subject to rights confirmation and editorial approval.
- Separate commerce for music downloads, beat licences and creative services.
- A small, early-stage audience with limited current streaming revenue.
- A platform capable of producing accurate play, track, composer, artist and territory logs.

Scope boundary: BAZ authorisation does not replace music copyright licensing. A ZIMURA blanket licence may not replace master-recording permission, BAZ approval, artist contracts, tax registration or other rights and regulatory requirements.

3. BAZ regulatory plan

BAZ's current published schedule, under S.I. 103 of 2026 dated 12 June 2026, lists the following fees for a **Webcasting / On-Demand Service**:

Fee	Published amount	Planning treatment
Application / renewal	US\$1,000	Assume payable at application and each renewal until BAZ confirms otherwise.
Annual regulatory fee	US\$3,450	Assume payable for the licence year; ask about timing, instalments and proration.
Total BAZ provision	US\$4,450	Ring-fence before filing.

Written questions for BAZ

1. Does one Webcasting / On-Demand licence cover BVS's continuous rotation and user-selected audio?
2. Is the US\$3,450 annual fee payable upfront, and are instalments or proration available?
3. What is the licence period and renewal date?
4. Which Zimbabwe entity, ownership, tax, technical, editorial and programme documents are required?
5. Does hosting outside Zimbabwe or serving listeners abroad change the classification?
6. Does an artist Premium subscription alter BVS's classification?
7. What reporting, local-content, recordkeeping, complaints and programme-code duties apply?

BVS should not assume the **Subscription Management Service** category applies. The published annual fee for that category starts at US\$50,000 and appears materially different from BVS's internet webcasting model. Classification must come from BAZ in writing.

4. ZIMURA negotiation plan

ZIMURA's current website describes online streaming as a broadcasting licence category but does not publish a fixed fee. The historical 2020 tariff mentioned US\$0.20 per viewer/listener per annum for webcasting; that figure is a negotiation reference only, not a current quote.

Recommended opening proposal

Term	BVS proposal
Term	12-month startup pilot
Minimum	US\$120 annually
Variable royalty	2% of net revenue directly attributable to licensed music streaming
First-year cap	US\$300
Reporting	Quarterly usage and revenue report
Review thresholds	5,000 monthly active listeners, 50,000 monthly streams, or US\$1,500 monthly streaming revenue

Relevant revenue should include streaming advertising, streaming sponsorship and listener subscriptions. It should exclude mixing/mastering services, beat sales, artist deposits, unrelated shop sales and other revenue not generated by the licensed music use.

If ZIMURA requires listener-based pricing, BVS's fallback proposal is US\$0.20 per annual unique listener, subject to a US\$100 minimum and US\$500 first-year cap.

5. Rights and product boundaries

BAZ

Regulatory authority for the broadcasting/webcasting service, licensing class and operational standards.

ZIMURA

Music copyright/blanket repertoire licence for represented compositions and eligible royalty distributions.

Artists / labels

Direct permission for master recordings, artwork, metadata, platform streaming, downloads and takedown processes.

BVS commerce

Beat licences, downloads, creative services and future distribution require separate terms and accurate rights confirmation.

BVS should request from ZIMURA: the current approved tariff; sample agreement; represented repertoire and territories; reporting format; treatment of direct-licensed works; on-demand treatment; deductions/administration; audit terms; and effective licence date.

6. Year-one financial plan

Cost area	Target	High provision
BAZ application/renewal + annual fee	US\$4,450	US\$4,450
ZIMURA pilot	US\$120–300	US\$500
Contract/application/legal review	US\$300	US\$600
Reporting, filing and contingency	US\$480	US\$500
Total reserve	US\$5,350	US\$6,050

This budget excludes ordinary hosting, payment processing, company/tax formation, marketing, production, staff, and distribution-partner costs.

Suggested funding mix

Source	Target contribution	Purpose
Founder/company capital	US\$2,500–3,000	Core regulatory commitment
Launch sponsor/advertising partner	US\$1,500–2,000	BAZ and launch compliance
Artist Premium pre-sales	US\$1,000–1,500	Platform and reporting reserve

7. BVS Premium pricing

Offer	Recommended price	Position
Founding Premium	US\$9/month or US\$90/year	Limited to the first 25–50 artists.
Standard Premium	US\$12/month or US\$120/year	Introduced after licensing and partner-cost validation.
DSP distribution	Separate / TBD	Do not promise or price until the distributor and actual costs are confirmed.

BAZ should be treated as company overhead funded across sponsorship, advertising, shop margin, services and subscriptions. It should not appear as a direct per-artist “BAZ licence fee.”

- BAZ alone requires approximately 42 artists paying US\$9 monthly for twelve uninterrupted months, before costs.
- A US\$6,000 compliance reserve requires approximately 56 artists paying US\$9 monthly, before costs.
- The company should therefore not rely solely on Premium subscriptions to finance first-year compliance.

8. Action plan and approval gates

1. **Prepare a two-page regulator brief:** ownership/entity, product architecture, content model, audience, revenue model, technical delivery and recordkeeping.
2. **Request written BAZ classification:** confirm the correct licence, payment timing and one-licence coverage.
3. **Secure US\$5,500 minimum:** keep the fund ring-fenced until classification and application documents are ready.
4. **Submit BAZ application:** pay only against the official portal/invoice and retain proof.
5. **Negotiate ZIMURA pilot:** use the US\$120 + 2% capped offer and obtain the repertoire/reporting terms in writing.
6. **Complete direct-rights framework:** artist master licence, composition declarations, takedown process and commerce permissions.
7. **Launch compliant pricing:** founding Premium first; standard Premium only after partner and regulatory costs are validated.
8. **Publish claims carefully:** do not claim “licensed by BAZ/ZIMURA” until the relevant licence/agreement is effective.

9. Sources and status

- BAZ, “Broadcasting Licensing Fees,” S.I. 103 of 2026: baz.co.zw/services/broadcasters/licensing-fees
- BAZ, “Licence Classifications”: new.baz.co.zw/services/broadcasters/license-types
- BAZ, fee reduction announcement, 12 June 2026: baz.co.zw/resources/news/baz-announces-reduction-of-broadcasting-regulatory-fees
- ZIMURA, “Licensing Information”: zimura.co.zw/licensing
- ZIMURA, “Frequently Asked Questions”: zimura.co.zw/faq
- 2 Broke Twimbos, “ZIMURA Explains Its New Blanket License Fees,” 28 July 2020: 2broketwimbos.com

Prepared on 28 July 2026 from publicly available information. Statutory fees and regulator interpretations can change. BVS management should obtain written classification, current invoices and professional legal review before committing funds or making compliance claims.